



A STORY FOR

Hoor & Alyaz

Ten days in South Africa. Penguins, lions, and one very big mountain.



Once upon a winter

Ten hours south of home the plane came down at the very bottom of Africa.
It was winter here, jumper weather, and the whole ocean was waiting.



Camps Bay

Their first bed sat between a golden beach and twelve stone giants called the Apostles. Every evening the sky went orange, and Alyaz hunted for shells.



The table in the sky

A little round cable car spun them up a mountain with a flat top, like a table.
When the wind blows, the mountain pulls a cloud over it like a tablecloth.



The penguins of Boulders

They waddled right up to the boardwalk, close enough to count. And one of them, just one, had put on a tuxedo and a little top hat, as if he had been expecting her.



The bottom of Africa

At Cape Point two whole oceans crash into each other. A baboon sat on a rock and thought very seriously about stealing their sandwich.



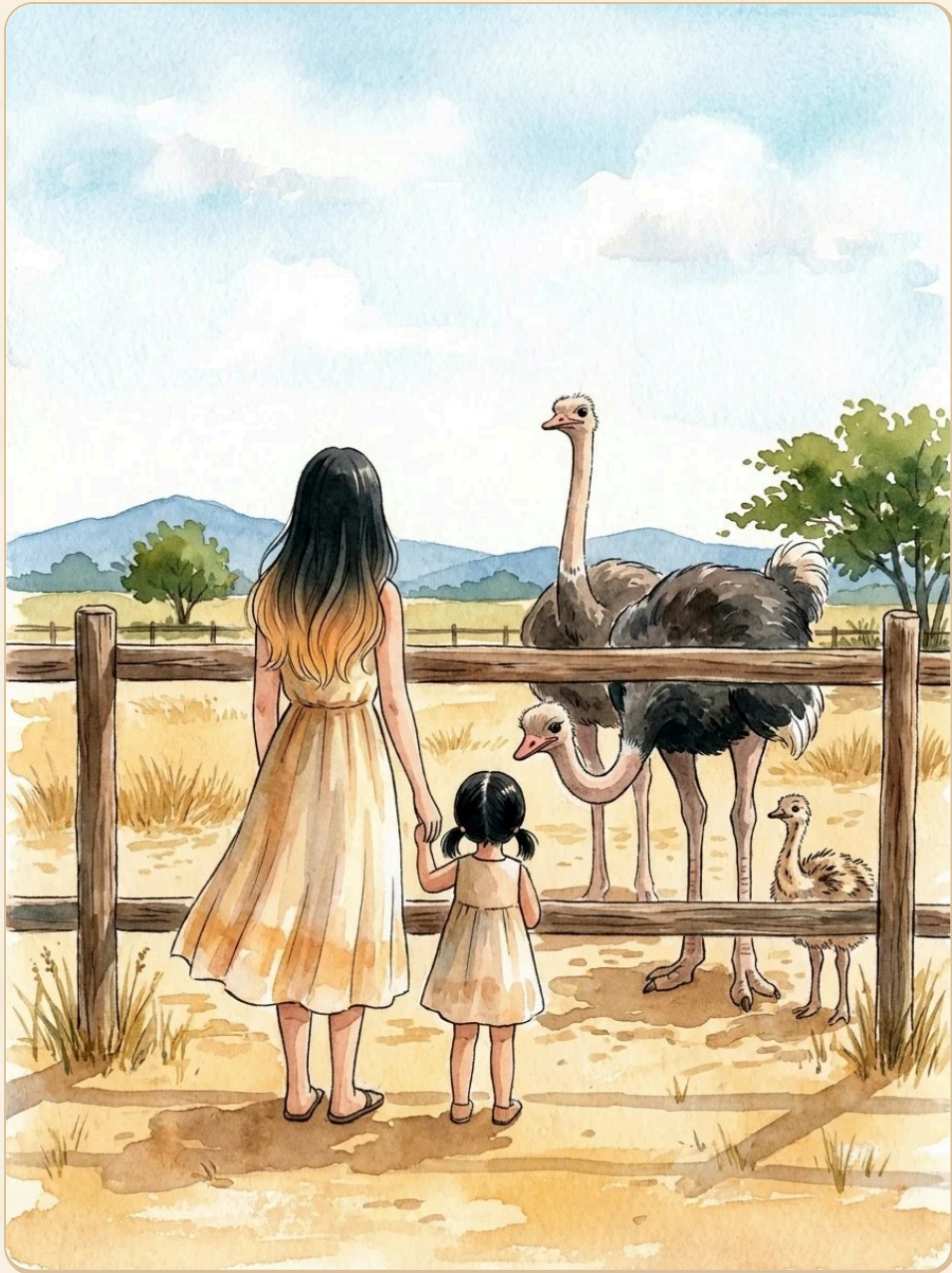
The rainbow street

In Bo-Kaap the houses are pink and lime and turquoise, as if somebody had spilled a paintbox all the way down the hill.



Drums for dinner

At GOLD they ate a dish from a different African country every single course, while the drummers played so loudly that Alyaz's plate buzzed.



The tallest bird

On the long road to the lions they stopped at a farm. The ostriches were taller than Mama. One of them bent all the way down to say hello to Alyaz.



Where the lions live

Then they went out to the long grass, and there were lions. Real ones. And an elephant that said hello with its trunk. Alyaz forgot how to breathe for a second.



The big wheel

Back at the harbour the seals clapped on the jetty, and a giant wheel lifted them up over all the little lights of the city.



The whale said goodbye

And far along the coast a whale the size of a bus lifted its great tail out of the sea, just to wave.



The end

Ten days. Three beds. One very lucky little explorer.